



PROGRESS REPORT

Lesotho: progress report, August 2025 – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 69 systems and instruments tracked

GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS · WHERE THE RECORD IS THIN

This report asks the same set of questions of every country. The rows below are a fixed frame of indicators, one row each, chosen in advance and covering all thirty-eight subjects the base tracks — so what appears here is decided by the frame and not by whichever records happened to accumulate. Each row says what happened on that indicator during the period, with every claim linked to the source it rests on.

Where a row reads *No evidence*, the base holds nothing on that indicator. **That is a statement about this base, not about the country** — it does not mean nothing exists, only that nothing has been collected here yet. The rows that carry evidence say what it is; the rows that do not are left to speak for themselves.

The period is 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-27.

Progress values. *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a reported position worsened. *Mixed* — the indicator's instruments moved in different directions in the period; the clause after the comma names which moved which way. *No change* — the base holds a standing position and nothing in the period touched it. *No evidence* — the base holds nothing on this indicator at all. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, regulations still pending*.

Governance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Digital transformation strategy	The National Digital Transformation Strategy: Agenda 2030 has been in force unamended since 2024, with no review or successor on file. The strategy was launched in 2024 and stands unamended (strategy). No mid-term review, progress report, costing or delivery schedule under it has been published, so the base holds the instrument and no account of what it has moved.	NO CHANGE
Strategies, plans and policies	ICT strategy	The National Digital Policy 2024 remains in force and unamended, sitting alongside the transformation strategy issued the same year. The policy was issued in 2024 and is recorded as in force, unamended (policy). Nothing on file records an implementation plan, a regulator instruction issued under it, or any assessment of its effect.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Broadband strategy	A Broadband Infrastructure Sharing Policy was signed by the communications minister in June 2026, with no implementation instrument on record. The minister signed the policy on 12 June 2026, one of three digital policies signed together (signing). The text itself is not held, so its obligations on licensees cannot be stated. The 2025/26 budget speech had recorded the drafts as validated, and no regulator guidance under the signed policy has been published since (budget speech).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data storage / cloud strategy	A national data-centre implementation roadmap went into drafting at a six-ministry Maseru workshop in August 2026; no text yet exists. The five-day workshop opened on 17 August 2026, organised by the communications ministry with the United Nations in Lesotho and coordinated by the UN Office for Digital and Emerging Technologies (workshop). The roadmap covers data governance, skills, compute, energy, cooling, financing and implementation choices, and builds on the artificial-intelligence, data-management and broadband policies validated in draft in January 2025 (roadmap). No publication date, custodian or cost is stated, and its relationship to the separately recorded Kobong data centre is not stated.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data interoperability framework / roadmap		NO EVIDENCE
Strategies, plans and policies	AI strategy	A National AI Policy was signed in June 2026 and a separate National AI Strategy went into drafting in August; neither text is held. The policy was signed by the communications minister on 12 June 2026, covering responsible artificial intelligence in health, education and public administration (signing , account). Its text is not held, so its scope and commitments cannot be stated. A distinct National AI Strategy was being drafted at a Maseru workshop that opened on 17 August 2026, intended as the framework for deployment; the deputy prime minister's keynote asked for capability assessment, safeguards, infrastructure, policy and human capacity to be settled before investment is widened (strategy).	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Data localisation policies		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Strategies, plans and policies	Data governance policy	A Data Management Policy was signed in June 2026 as a privacy, security and ethical-use framework, and a data value blueprint is in drafting. The minister signed the Data Management Policy on 12 June 2026 (signing), and its text is not held. Drafting of a National Data Value Creation Blueprint opened at a first national consultative workshop on 14 and 15 July 2026, with no text yet in existence (workshop). The country's membership of the Smart Africa programme behind it rests on a spokesperson's remarks carried by the government news agency.	ADVANCED
Strategies, plans and policies	Open data policy		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Data protection legislation	The Data Protection Act 2011 remains in force and unamended, on the most recent account held, dated March 2026. The Act has been in force since 2011 and was recorded as unamended as at 23 March 2026 (review). No amendment, regulation or commencement instrument has been published since, and the base holds no enforcement action, complaint count or guidance issued under it.	NO CHANGE
Legislation and regulation	Cybersecurity legislation	The Computer Crime and Cybersecurity Bill was split into a Cybercrime Bill and a Cybersecurity Bill, both awaiting National Assembly approval. Both bills were reported on 29 July 2026 as awaiting National Assembly approval, on no published timetable (forum , account). The Cybersecurity Bill is intended to build the institutions protecting critical digital infrastructure, which is the statute the interim response team now operating was set up ahead of (interim body). No text of either bill is held.	ADVANCED
Legislation and regulation	Legislation covering digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Digital payments legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Legislation enabling data interoperability		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	AI legislation / regulations		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	E-commerce legislation		NO EVIDENCE
Legislation and regulation	Statistics legislation		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Legislation and regulation	Access to information legislation	A 2021 capacity assessment found no access-to-information legislation in force, and nothing since records one being enacted. The assessment carried out for the Millennium Challenge Corporation and the Lesotho Millennium Development Agency found no access-to-information statute in force in September 2021 (assessment). No bill, draft or commitment to one has appeared in the base in the five years since, so the absence is a searched one at that date and an unexamined one after it.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	Data protection authority	The Data Protection Commission is provided for by the 2011 Act but no commissioner had been appointed as at March 2026. The commission exists in law and not in fact: the 2011 Act provides for it, and the most recent account held records no commissioner appointed as at 23 March 2026 (review). Fifteen years after the statute, the base holds no appointment, no budget line, no staff and no supervisory decision from it.	NO CHANGE
Data protection	National data protection readiness	A US\$364m health agreement with the United States carries data-sharing agreements that have not been published, after a brief release was withdrawn. The agreement was signed in December 2025 and stated at US\$364m (complaint). The State Department published a subset of the memoranda in March 2026 and then removed public access, and the related data-sharing agreements have not been published. Lesotho is one of sixteen countries named in a freedom-of-information suit filed on 2 April 2026 that remains unresolved, and African governments had already pushed back on the health deals over data and power (reporting).	REGRESSED the data-sharing instrument behind a bilateral health agreement was briefly published and then withdrawn
Regional collaboration	Regional policy collaboration	Lesotho joined the 50-in-5 digital public infrastructure campaign as its fourteenth member in May 2024, and no milestone has been reported since. The country joined in May 2024 as the fourteenth member, with civil registration and its integration with digital public infrastructure named as the commitment (joining , profile). No milestone, review or output under the campaign has been reported for the country in the two years since.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Regional collaboration	Regional legal harmonisation	An African Union Data Policy Framework readiness workshop was convened in July 2025, and no assessment or resulting instrument is held. AUDA-NEPAD convened a readiness workshop from 28 to 31 July 2025 on domesticating the framework (workshop). No readiness assessment, legislative review or instrument has followed it into the base, so the domestication is recorded as convened and not as done.	NO CHANGE
Regional collaboration	Shared regional infrastructure		NO EVIDENCE
Regional collaboration	Cross-border data transfers	The only cross-border arrangement on file is the health data-sharing instrument with the United States, whose text is withheld. African governments pushed back during 2026 on United States health agreements over data and power, this country's among them (reporting). The data-sharing agreements attached to its own agreement have not been published, and the base holds no adequacy decision, transfer safeguard or domestic authorisation covering them (complaint).	NO CHANGE
Standards	National interoperability standards	A Government Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework has been under development since the 2025/26 budget, with no further detail published. The budget speech recorded the framework as under development, aimed at improving government efficiency and service delivery and at avoiding fragmented and costly infrastructure deployment across government (budget speech). No draft, adoption date, standards register or list of the systems bound by it has been published in the eighteen months since.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Standards	National quality standards	Quality-of-service rules have been in force since 2023, and the regulator's own testing puts compliance at 75 per cent with speeds far below target. Legal Notice No. 41 of 2023 came into force on 21 April 2023, prescribing minimum quality-of-service standards for voice, data, postal and courier licensees across accessibility, integrity and retainability, with two published schedules of measurable parameters (rules). The two mobile operators reached 75 per cent overall compliance across twelve general parameters in the year to 31 March 2025, missing on disconnection-complaint resolution time and mobile order-completion time (annual report). Drive-testing across three Maseru clusters in November 2025 found mean download speeds of 2.88 to 2.95 Mbps against a 25 Mb/s target, and unsuccessful call ratios of 2.6 to 6.2 per cent against a 2 per cent ceiling (testing).	MIXED quality-of-service rules in force and measured, with two parameters missed and speeds far below the target
Standards	Adoption of international standards		NO EVIDENCE
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Non-governmental contribution to national policy	A standing National Cybersecurity Forum was constituted in July 2026, spanning government, industry, regulators, banks and telecommunications providers. The forum held its inaugural meeting on 29 July 2026 and is standing rather than convened for an occasion (launch , account). It is the only structured route on file by which bodies outside government contribute to national digital policy, and no terms of reference, membership list or output from it has been published (report).	ADVANCED
Public debate and participation in policymaking	Open discussion of government policy	The one public contest on file is an allegation of political interference in regulator appointments, denied by the ministry and unanswered by the regulator. The outgoing chief licensing officer at the communications authority alleged at a media briefing reported on 22 August 2026 that the communications minister pressed the board to re-advertise the post rather than renew the five-year contract that expired on 31 May 2026, and that the universal service fund's executive secretary was removed in the same way (briefing). The minister stated the ministry has no role in recruiting the authority's managers, and the authority declined to comment. It is an allegation with a ministerial denial and no regulator response, and the base holds no inquiry into it.	ADVANCED

Finance

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure	Sustainable domestic financing of digital transformation	The 2025/26 budget appropriated M381.1 million to the sector, naming a security operations centre, an interoperability framework and fibre works. The budget speech of 19 February 2025 allocated M381.1 million to the sector and named its intended uses: a Government Security Operations Centre, a Government of Lesotho Enterprise Architecture and Interoperability Framework, a completed fibre feasibility study, 17 operational base tower stations and a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka (budget speech). No outturn, disbursement figure or later appropriation is held, so the base records what was voted and not what was spent.	ADVANCED
MoUs and other agreements	Strategic relationships	Smart Africa, the African Union and the German Embassy were named as supporters of the data blueprint work, with no programme document or amount held. The three were named as supporters at the first blueprint workshop in July 2026 (workshop). No terms of reference, programme document or amount is held for any of them, so the base records three named backers and nothing that any of them is committed to.	ADVANCED
New investments	Mobilisation of non-state finance	Project Kobong carries the largest private commitment on file, put by government at M100bn and by the developer at about US\$6.2bn. The government figure was M98bn in June 2026 and M100bn in August (approval , tribune account); the developer's chief executive states about US\$6.2bn of capital investment, while the developer's own release of 8 June 2026 states no value (release). The commitment rests on a binding memorandum of agreement of 4 June 2026 and is conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (memorandum).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
New investments	Development-partner project financing	Partner money carries two named projects: an African Development Bank e-government phase and a UNICEF learning dashboard. The African Development Bank committed US\$13.95m to the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project in 2019, with US\$16.5m disbursed and the project ending in 2026 (commitment); a Digital Outreach Studio was launched under it in June 2026 (studio). UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for a foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support).	ADVANCED

ICT Infrastructure

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile penetration	The larger operator reports 1.21m customers and 85 per cent market share, and the other has 149 5G sites on 700MHz. The thirtieth-anniversary account of June 2026 gives 1.21m customers, 85 per cent market share, 422 base stations of which 101 are solar, and coverage of 97 per cent on 2G, 98 per cent on 3G and 96 per cent on 4G (account). A US\$40m phased network upgrade was announced in March 2026 (upgrade), following an upgrade pledged at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 (visit). The second operator grew its 5G sites from 54 to 149 on 700MHz by June 2025, and no later figure is held (5G , network).	ADVANCED
Connectivity	Internet usage	The ministry puts broadband coverage at 100 per cent against about 50 per cent regular internet use, a gap no programme on file addresses directly. The communications ministry stated the two figures at the United Nations Global Dialogue on AI Governance in July 2026 (statement). No earlier measurement is held, so the level is recorded and the direction is not. The one product launched into that gap is a fixed-mobile convergence service, live since July 2025 with nothing later on record (service).	NO CHANGE a first statement of the gap with no earlier figure behind it

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Connectivity	Mobile affordability		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	National fibre backbone	A metropolitan fibre network has a completed feasibility study and no construction reported; a 96km Roma to Thaba-Tseka stretch was under way in 2025. The budget speech of February 2025 recorded the feasibility study for the Lesotho Metropolitan Fibre Distribution Network as completed, laying groundwork for high-speed broadband across the major towns, with construction not reported (feasibility). The same speech recorded a 96km fibre stretch from Roma to Thaba-Tseka under way and 17 base tower stations operational (budget speech). Eighteen months on, no completion, route map or capacity figure has been published for either.	ADVANCED
Connectivity	International internet bandwidth		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Internet Exchange Points		NO EVIDENCE
Connectivity	Satellite broadband licensing and availability	A ten-year satellite licence was granted in April 2025 over local-shareholding objections, and the service is live through a sole reseller. The communications authority granted a ten-year licence on 14 April 2025, contested over full foreign ownership: the incumbent appealed for local shareholding and a rights group objected (licence , objection). Nothing later on record resolves the objection. The service launched through T-Connect as exclusive reseller on 30 June 2025 (launch , account), and by January 2026 was reported also carried over the incumbent's low-earth-orbit backhaul (backhaul).	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (all providers)	Project Kobong was approved in July 2026 as a green-powered artificial-intelligence data centre at Mokhotlong, with construction targeted for 2029. The project was approved and launched at a ceremony hosted by the United States Embassy on 31 July 2026, on a binding memorandum covering pumped storage and a data centre at Mokhotlong, conditional on feasibility, financing, permitting and definitive agreements (approval , partnership). Construction is targeted for 2029 (account , first data centre). The base holds no operating commercial data-centre capacity in the country at all, so the whole of this indicator is a project not due to break ground for three years.	ADVANCED
Data Storage	Local data centre capacity (national providers)		NO EVIDENCE
Data Storage	Off-site backup capacity	A Tier III government data centre at Mohale's Hoek, designed as a 100km-separated backup to the Maseru facility, was near-complete in 2018 and unconfirmed since. The facility was toured near-complete by the communications minister in May 2018 under the e-Government Infrastructure Project, awaiting its power station, and designed as a backup separated by 100km from the finance ministry's Maseru data centre (tour). No source later than that tour confirms the power station's completion or the facility going live, so eight years on the country's only recorded off-site backup is of unknown status.	STALLED
Energy	Sufficient energy and water for data centres	Generation runs at about 72MW against about 209MW of demand, while Kobong plans at least 1,200MW of pumped storage for its data centre. About 72MW is installed against about 209MW of domestic demand, and 438 of the 970 GWh consumed in 2024 were imported (generation). The Kobong memorandum covers at least 1,200MW of pumped storage alongside a green-powered data centre, conditional on feasibility and financing and with construction targeted for 2029 (approval). No water assessment for the site is held, and no statement connects the new generation to the existing national deficit.	MIXED a national generation deficit against a dedicated pumped-storage scheme planned for the data centre
Energy	Grid reliability		NO EVIDENCE
Energy	Rural electrification		NO EVIDENCE
Technical Capacity	Robustness of government hardware and software		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Technical Capacity	Local capacity to maintain, manage and develop government systems	Government appointed its first chief information security officer and announced a plan to move ICT services out of the civil service into a separate agency. The first chief information security officer across government was reported appointed on 29 July 2026 (appointment , account). A separate government ICT agency was announced the same day, to take ICT services out of the civil service, with no enabling instrument, scope or date published (agency). Both are institutional rather than measured: the base holds no count of technical staff in government, no maintenance arrangement and no assessment of what the state can run without a vendor.	ADVANCED
Cybersecurity	National cybersecurity readiness	An interim national response team launched in July 2026 and a security operations centre is being stood up, against no national strategy at the last review. LesComCSIRT launched in Maseru on 29 July 2026 and operates on an interim basis, ahead of the statute intended to establish it (launch , account). A national security operations centre was reported being stood up the same month, having been budgeted as a Government Security Operations Centre in the 2025/26 budget speech; no host, operator or date is published (centre , budget). A capacity maturity review of March 2023 rated the strategy dimension at start-up and confirmed no official national cybersecurity strategy, and none has been published since (review).	ADVANCED

DPI

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Data Exchange	National data exchange system	X-Road was presented in February 2026 as one of three systems under development, with no go-live date published. The interoperability platform was presented at a joint ministry and university review of digital public infrastructure progress on 20 February 2026 (review). Once-only information exchange had been named a priority of the year in the memorandum with India signed in July 2025, with no platform then on record (memorandum). No go-live date, connected agency or transaction figure has been published.	ADVANCED
Data Exchange	Use of digital id in other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of health systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of education systems		NO EVIDENCE
Data Exchange	Interoperability of social protection systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Robustness of system	The National Identification System is in operation, and the most recent account held of it is a case study published in 2022. The system is recorded as in operation, documented in a World Bank GovTech case study of 2022 and in the same institution's service-delivery study of that year (case study , service delivery). No later coverage, enrolment or performance figure is held, and the independent research on digital identity in the country dates from 2021 (research).	NO CHANGE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Registration of entire population		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Identity and CRVS	National maintenance of id and credentials systems	A 2026 work plan with UNICEF commits to a MOSIP-based national identity platform covering passport and identity renewal and proof-of-life verification. The work plan was signed by the ministry and UNICEF on 3 March 2026, covering passport and identity renewal, biometric registration and proof-of-life verification on a MOSIP base (work plan). Digital identity pilots had begun under the memorandum with India, with no platform then named (memorandum), and the systems under development were reviewed with the national university in February 2026 (review). No procurement, vendor or go-live date is published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Authentication	A digital service-ID pilot of about 10,000 participants began in April 2026, requiring a national identity document, a registered SIM and biometric registration. The pilot was announced on 25 March 2026 to begin on 2 April with about 10,000 participants in a testing phase (pilot). Registration requires a valid national identity document, a registered SIM card and biometric registration. No vendor, legal basis or evaluation criteria is stated, and no result from the pilot has been published.	ADVANCED
Digital Identity and CRVS	Digital id from birth		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Interoperability of birth registration and digital id		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Identity and CRVS	Use by other systems		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Governance role of central bank	The central bank's national payment switch has localised instant payments, ATM and point-of-sale transactions across four commercial banks. LeSwitch carries instant payments from 2022, ATM localisation from October 2024 and point-of-sale localisation from 11 May 2025, across four commercial banks (point of sale, central bank, switch). E-commerce and retail were named as the next steps and nothing later is held, so the switch's coverage is recorded as at May 2025.	NO CHANGE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	G2P functionality	The only government-to-person channel on file carries 20,000 Child Grants Programme beneficiaries on digital grant payments. Digital grant payments to 20,000 beneficiaries of the Child Grants Programme were in operation when the digital birth registration programme launched in April 2025 (programme). No later enrolment figure, payment volume or extension to another transfer is held, and no other government payment stream is recorded as digital.	NO CHANGE
Digital Payments and Fintech	Revenue collection	Tax e-payment integration went live in February 2026 for company tax, pay-as-you-earn, value-added tax and customs duties. Revenue Services Lesotho and Standard Lesotho Bank launched the integration on 11 February 2026, reachable over USSD, internet banking and the bank's mobile application (launch). No collection figure, share of receipts taken electronically, or extension to a second bank has been published since.	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	B2B and B2G functionality		NO EVIDENCE
Digital Payments and Fintech	P2P, P2G and P2B functionality	A wallet investment service launched in July 2026 over USSD, from M50 for individual customers and M300 for group-savings customers. Tsetela launched in Maseru on 22 July 2026 over a USSD short code, from M50 for individual mobile-money customers and M300 for group-savings customers, with the asset manager licensed by the Central Bank of Lesotho (launch , account). It is the first investment product reachable from a wallet on record (report), and no subscriber or value figure has been published since (coverage).	ADVANCED
Digital Payments and Fintech	Population uptake	Mobile money was spun into a separately constituted entity with 14,000 agents, while the second wallet has been unchanged since 2024. The mobile money business was spun off into VCL Financial Services on 13 March 2026 (spin-off) and reported 14,000 agents by June 2026 (anniversary). EcoCash completed a platform migration in October 2024 with group savings, payroll and fraud detection integrated, and wallet interest payouts stated as forthcoming; nothing later is held (migration). No account or active-user figure is published for either.	ADVANCED

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digital Payments and Fintech	Cross-border functionality	Renminbi settlement became available through a commercial bank in July 2026, while migrant workers moved to fintechs as South African rules tightened. Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access). Migrant workers remitting from South Africa moved from banks to fintechs as South African remittance and banking rules tightened, reported in June 2026 (remittances). No corridor volume, price or regional switch connection is published.	MIXED a new renminbi settlement route against migrant workers pushed out of bank channels
Digital Payments and Fintech	Consumer protection		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Population register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Civil register	Digital birth registration has been in operation since April 2025 under a programme run with the European Union and UNICEF, with no later enrolment figure. The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF (launch). No registration count, coverage share or link to the national identification system has been published since, so the base records that the registration is digital and not how much of the population it reaches.	NO CHANGE
Registries	Address register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Business register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Social protection register	NISSA holds data on more than 90 per cent of households and has a child-centred redesign piloted in one district. The registry holds data on more than 90 per cent of households, categorised by vulnerability, and a child-centred redesign was piloted in Mafeteng District under the Universal DPI Safeguards Framework (redesign). The registry and its companion management information system were procured together in 2024 (procurement). No update to the coverage figure and no evaluation of the redesign is held.	ADVANCED
Registries	Electoral register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Tax register		NO EVIDENCE
Registries	Land register		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Sectoral management information systems	Health	A consultancy was advertised in August 2026 to strengthen the national AIDS commission's capacity to coordinate monitoring and evaluation reporting. The tender was advertised on 16 August 2026 (advertisement). It is a tender rather than an award, and no value, duration or reporting system is named. The base holds no health management information system for the country, so the only health-data movement on record is a request for help coordinating reporting.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Education	A foundational literacy and numeracy dashboard is under construction for Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools. UNICEF and the Global Partnership for Education announced support on 23 July 2026 for the dashboard, covering Grades 1 to 3, with tablets for principals in 300 project schools and solar power in 25 cluster learning spaces (support). No go-live date, data source or coverage beyond the project schools is published, and no wider education management information system is held for the country.	ADVANCED
Sectoral management information systems	Social protection	The MISSA social-assistance management information system was put to tender in 2024, and no award or delivery is on record. The request for proposals closed on 12 August 2024, and nothing since records an award, a contract or a delivery (procurement). An earlier management information system was built between November 2014 and January 2016, so the country has had one and does not now have a recorded successor.	STALLED
Sectoral management information systems	Justice		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Tax		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Customs		NO EVIDENCE
Sectoral management information systems	Land		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Other GovTech and e-Gov	e-government services	An e-Parliament system was completed, a digital outreach studio opened, and a decision support system is under development. The 2025/26 budget speech reported the e-Parliament system implemented, described as a milestone in modernising legislative processes, with no further detail published (budget speech). A Digital Outreach Studio was launched in June 2026 under the second phase of the eGovernment Infrastructure Project (studio). A decision support system for planning and budgeting was presented as under development in February 2026, with no scope, host or date published (review).	ADVANCED

Digitalisation

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Digitalisation of sub-national government	ICT infrastructure for local government		NO EVIDENCE
Digitalisation of sub-national government	Digitalisation of local government records	A construction permit system is live at the capital's city council, taking applications, documents, staged review and permit issue online. The Maseru City Council construction permit automation system is live, providing online application, document upload, staged review, message and email notifications, auto-generated invoices and digital permit issue (system). It was built by a Lesotho firm with a Kenyan partner under World Bank private-sector competitiveness funding. No permit volume, processing time or extension to a second council is published.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural health clinics		NO EVIDENCE
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural primary schools	A school and clinic connectivity programme opened at a Butha-Buthe school in January 2026, after community hotspots in three rural places. T-Connect Impact launched at Soofia International School in Butha-Buthe on 17 January 2026 (launch). It followed the first community hotspots handed over at Matsieng, Thaba Bosiu and Mokhotlong in September 2025 (hotspots). No count of connected schools is published, no clinic is named, and no national programme for rural school connectivity is held.	ADVANCED
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural registry offices		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Rural digital data capture	Digitalisation of rural police stations		NO EVIDENCE

Technology

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
AI	Use of AI in government administration		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Use of AI in sectoral management information systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Development of national / regional AI systems		NO EVIDENCE
AI	Control of AI abuse		NO EVIDENCE
ICT Industry	National capacity in DT-related production	A Lesotho firm built the capital's permit system with a Kenyan partner, and two local firms hosted an executive cloud and security workshop. Computer Business Solutions of Lesotho built the Maseru City Council permit system with Web Masters of Kenya under World Bank funding (system). The same firm and DNS Technologies hosted an executive workshop in Maseru on 30 May 2026 on ransomware, cloud security, data sovereignty and immutable backup (workshop). Those are the only two records of domestic technology production or service capability in the base.	ADVANCED
Innovation ecosystem	Technology hubs		NO EVIDENCE
Innovation ecosystem	Tech startup ecosystem	A UNDP and Econet memorandum was renewed in July 2026 across three pillars, one of them small-business digital entrepreneurship. The memorandum was signed at Maseru on 28 July 2026, renewing a partnership first signed in 2020 and amended in 2022 (signing , account). Its three pillars are digital transformation, connectivity and artificial intelligence; support for innovation; and digital entrepreneurship among micro, small and medium enterprises. No amount, term or deliverable is stated, and no count of new firms or of firms reached is held.	ADVANCED

Capacity

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (civil service)		NO EVIDENCE

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Literacy	Digital literacy (general population)	Government digital-literacy training was reported running across all ten districts in July 2026, with no participant numbers published. The training was reported running in every district on 29 July 2026 (forum , account). No participant count, curriculum, duration or completion figure has been published (report), so the base records national reach and no measure of what it delivers.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	DT-related training in secondary education		NO EVIDENCE
Training and skills	DT-related university facilities and qualifications	A National AI Academy is proposed in a signed memorandum, with no timetable, governance, curriculum or host institution named. The academy was named in the memorandum signed by UNDP and Econet on 28 July 2026 (memorandum , signing). No timetable, governance structure, curriculum or host institution is named, and the base holds no existing university department, qualification or facility in these subjects for the country.	ADVANCED
Training and skills	Graduates entering DT ecosystem	An AI skills programme began in June 2026, reported as the country's first, while a corporate training pledge has delivered nothing in twelve months. The AI Skills Development Programme launched with the United States Embassy under the Sebatatso initiative on 17 June 2026, reported as the country's first digital-entrepreneurship and artificial-intelligence tools training (programme). Digital-skills training pledged by a mobile group and a cloud provider at the group chief executive's visit in August 2025 has nothing on record delivered in the twelve months since (pledge). No participant, completion or placement figure is published for either.	MIXED a first artificial-intelligence skills programme running against a corporate training pledge undelivered a year on
Research institutions	Think tanks and academic departments contributing to DT policy	One joint review of digital public infrastructure with the national university's mathematics and computer science department is the whole of the record. The ministry and the National University of Lesotho reviewed digital public infrastructure progress together on 20 February 2026 (review). No research programme, funding, publication or output has followed it into the base, and no other academic body or think tank is recorded contributing to digital policy.	NO CHANGE

Inclusion

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
Access to services	Citizen feedback portals		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Citizen participation in policy	A public survey of digital services experience opened in August 2026 covering access, usability, trust and skills gaps. The survey opened on 9 August 2026, run by the ministry with the United Nations development programme as part of a donor-backed digital readiness assessment, and covers online applications, digital payments and health and education platforms (survey). No closing date, sample target or commitment to publish the results is stated, so the base records that citizens were asked and not that the answers will be seen.	ADVANCED
Access to services	Gender equity		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of persons with disabilities		NO EVIDENCE
Access to services	Inclusion of refugees and IDPs		NO EVIDENCE
Digital divides	Bridging of digital divides		NO EVIDENCE

Data

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
National statistics	National strategy for development of statistics		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Censuses and surveys		NO EVIDENCE
National statistics	Statistics from administrative data		NO EVIDENCE
Open data	Use of open data	A 2021 assessment found no active government open-data programme and no portal, and nothing since records one. The capacity assessment of September 2021 found no government open-data activity (assessment). A civil-society open data initiative launched in 2019, and the country ranked 151st of 187 in the 2020 Open Data Inventory. No government portal, dataset catalogue or publication commitment has appeared in the base in the five years since.	NO CHANGE
Use of satellite data	Agricultural use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE
Use of satellite data	Meteorological use of satellite data		NO EVIDENCE

Geopolitics

TOPIC	INDICATOR	DEVELOPMENTS	PROGRESS
US / hyperscaler activities	USA / hyperscaler MoUs, engagements and commitments	The United States Embassy states US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated over eighteen months, of which the data-centre project is the largest. The embassy's own figure, carried as such, is US\$7.3bn of commercial partnerships facilitated in the country over the previous eighteen months, with Kobong the largest of them (statement). The embassy also launched an artificial-intelligence skills programme under the Sebatatso initiative in June 2026 (programme). No hyperscaler commitment, data-centre region or cloud agreement with a United States provider is recorded.	ADVANCED
China activities	Chinese MoUs, engagements and commitments	Chinese engagement on file is a single financial route: renminbi settlement reaching the country through a commercial bank in July 2026. Standard Bank extended access to China's cross-border interbank payment system beyond South Africa to five markets including Lesotho, reported on 27 July 2026 (access). No Chinese vendor contract, memorandum, loan or infrastructure project is recorded for the country in this base, which makes the payment route the whole of the relationship on record.	ADVANCED
EU activities	EU MoUs, engagements and commitments	European engagement on file is the digital birth registration programme run with the European Union and UNICEF since April 2025. The programme launched on 2 April 2025 with the European Union and UNICEF as partners (launch). No value, term or wider European digital engagement is recorded, and no European Union instrument covering the country's digital transformation is held.	NO CHANGE
Gulf/UAE activities	Gulf MoUs, engagements and commitments		NO EVIDENCE
India activities	India MoUs, engagements and commitments	The memorandum with India of July 2025 named digital identity, a unified payment environment and once-only exchange as priorities, and nothing under it is on record. The memorandum was signed during the Indian minister of state's visit to Maseru on 29 July 2025, naming those three priorities for the year (memorandum). No deliverable, workstream or funding under it is on record a year later, though both the identity and the interoperability workstreams recorded elsewhere in this ledger cite it as their starting point.	NO CHANGE

Where the record is thin

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
National Cybersecurity Strategy	The text of the strategy the minister invoked at the LesComCSIRT launch, or an official statement of its adoption date, version and targets. The 2022 Cybersecurity Capacity Maturity Model review states Lesotho had no official national strategy.	2026-08-10
National open data portal	A government open-data portal or published open-data policy for Lesotho, or an official statement that none exists.	2026-08-10

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